



No matter the platform, a child's activities can be monitored

we aren't fear-mongering to sell easy solutions. Fear is also a gateway to vigilance and caution, which are necessary traits in an unpredictable world. And while most adults have acquired a sensible approach towards how securely they use technology, we've all seen cases of abuse and violations. Be it leaked government secrets or stolen private content – the perils of having anything on the web is acutely well known by adults. However, kids are not acclimated to this reality and educating them about the risks is a slow and gradual process.

Never before in the history of India, or for that matter the world, have more people been so closely connected. Communication has become the backbone of all industries, and the speed of contact is unprecedented. Long gone are the days of pre-booked long distance trunk calls and postal services. Today, most people are reachable on their mobile phones and email. And for kids who transverse this space, it's more natural for them to have a Facebook page than to know their full postal address. However, the spectrum of intimacy which children share with these technologies varies by age. While no kid under six years is likely to be running their own Facebook or Twitter page, that can radically shift as kids begin to socialise in the real world.

As per recent estimates by researchers at Common Sense Media, in an urban household, children under the ages of 12 consume more than three hours of media per day. This persistent usage includes all forms of digital engagement and content, from computers to tablets. Interestingly, this